[redacted]

DECLASSIFIED
By Deputy Archivist of the U.S.
By W. J. Stewart Date MAR 5 1972

PRIORITY 30 DECEMBER 1943

FROM: WAR
TO : AMMISCA, CHUNGKING #4092

PERSONAL AND ~~SECRET~~ FROM THE PRESIDENT FOR GENERAL STILWELL'S EYES ALONE.

THE PRESIDENT DESIRES THAT YOU HAND THE FOLLOWING MESSAGE TO THE GENERALISSIMO:

"YOUR TWO MESSAGES WERE RECEIVED BY ME ON MY RETURN. YOUR ACCEPTANCE OF THE STRATEGY OF CONCENTRATING ALL NECESSARY MEANS TO DEFEAT GERMANY FIRST UNITES ALL OF US COMPLETELY.

"I FULLY APPRECIATE THE MILITARY AND ECONOMIC SITUATION IN CHINA AS OUTLINED BY YOU. I AM STILL CONVINCED, THAT UNDER THE CIRCUMSTANCES, THE MAJOR CONTRIBUTION THAT WE CAN MAKE TO RELIEVE THE PRESENT SITUATION IN CHINA IS TO UNDERTAKE DURING THIS DRY SEASON, THE DRIVING OF A LAND ROUTE OF SUPPLY ACROSS BURMA TO CHINA. THE OPERATIONS REQUIRED TO ACCOMPLISH THIS WOULD IN THE MEANTIME RESULT IN MUCH GREATER SECURITY FOR THE AIR TRANSPORT ROUTE AND ENABLE US TO REDUCE LOSSES OF OUR PLANES BY ENEMY ACTION. PLANS ARE NOW BEING MADE BY MOUNTBATTEN TO UNDERTAKE OPERATIONS ON AS LARGE A SCALE AS MAY BE POSSIBLE WITH THE RESOURCES AVAILABLE TO HIM, AND IT IS HOPED THAT YOU WILL CONTINUE TO MAKE EVERY PRACTICABLE EFFORT TO GET YOUR YUNNAN FORCE PREPARED TO BEGIN OPERATIONS IN NORTH BURMA IN SUPPORT OF OUR EFFORT WITH BRITISH AND AMERICAN FORCES FROM INDIA.

"AS TO THE AIR FORCES IN CHINA, YOU ARE WELL AWARE THAT THE FULL POTENTIAL EFFECTIVENESS OF CHENNAULT'S FORCES IS STILL SEVERELY LIMITED BY SUPPLY DIFFICULTIES. WE MUST STRIVE FIRST, THEREFORE, TO IMPROVE THE LINES OF COMMUNICATION AND THE AIR FERRY ROUTE TO CHINA BEFORE COMMITTING OURSELVES TO ANY FURTHER INCREASE OF THE AIR FORCES IN CHINA BEYOND PRESENT

[redacted]

DECLASSIFIED
By Deputy Archivist of the U.S.
By W. J. Stewart Date MAR 1972

SECRET

ARRANGEMENTS.

"AS YOU KNOW, PREPARATIONS ARE NOW BEING MADE TO UNDERTAKE VERY LONG RANGE AIR OPERATIONS AGAINST JAPAN PROPER FROM THE AREA IN CHINA YOU KNOW ABOUT. THE EFFECT OF CARRYING THE ATTACK BY THIS MEANS TO THE VERY HEART OF THE ENEMY SHOULD DO MUCH TO HEIGHTEN THE MORALE OF BOTH OUR NATIONS.

"REGARDING THE AIR FERRY ROUTE, THERE ARE ABOUT 100 LARGE TRANSPORT AIRCRAFT NOW ON THE WAY OR BEING PREPARED FOR MOVEMENT TO THE THEATER. THESE PLANES SHOULD GO FAR TO MAKE POSSIBLE THE EARLY ATTAINMENT OF OUR PRESENT TARGET CAPACITY FOR THE AIR ROUTE. WE WILL CONTINUE STRIVING WITH UTMOST ENERGY TO BUILD UP THIS ROUTE, AND TO IMPROVE OPERATING CONDITIONS. IT IS YET TOO EARLY, HOWEVER, TO PREDICT WHAT ACTUAL ADDITIONAL CAPACITY CAN BE ACHIEVED. OUR BUILDUP, MEANWHILE, WILL BE DIRECTED TOWARD ATTAINING AN EARLY GOAL OF 12,000 TONS PER MONTH. WE BELIEVE THAT THIS CAN BE REACHED PROVIDED THERE IS NO DIVERSION OF THE AIRCRAFT ALLOCATED TO THE AIR TRANSPORT ROUTE, AND PROVIDED A JAPANESE INTERRUPTION OF THE AIR LINE IS PREVENTED BY THE ADVANCE OF OUR LAND FORCES.

"THE QUESTION OF A LOAN AND RELATED FINANCIAL MATTERS IS BEING WORKED ON BY THE TREASURY DEPARTMENT AND I WILL WIRE YOU VERY SOON."

ROOSEVELT

Released from the White House Map Room
at 1320, EWT, 20 December 1943.

L. MATHEWSON,
Colonel, General Staff.

SECRET